BİLİŞİM VADİSİ | 42 TÜRKİYE | VAKIF KATILIM

HACKATHON
ROOT&CODE

# ROOT & CODE HACKATHON

# TERMS AND CONDITIONS

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## DEFINITIONS AND ABBREVIATIONS

As specified in these terms and conditions:

- **Competition:** KÖK&KOD Hackathon, organized in collaboration with Vakıf Katılım and 42 Türkiye for the 42 Türkiye & 42 campuses around the world,
- **Team:** A group of 2 to 4 participants who apply to the Competition together and meet the participation requirements specified in these Terms and Conditions,
- **Team Leader (Contact Person):** The person responsible for the team's organization and official communication with Bilişim Vadisi,
- **MVP (Minimum Viable Product):** The minimum viable product with the core user flows functioning and capable of demonstrating the product's main value proposition,
- **Dataset:** The semi-structured content package consisting of verified texts, images, and sources relating to foundation works, which is planned to be made available to the participants by the sponsoring organization,
- **Bilişim Vadisi:** The organization responsible for organizing the Competition, enforcing the rules, and conducting the evaluation processes,
- **42 Türkiye:** The educational organization operating under Bilişim Vadisi and encompassing the 42 Istanbul and 42 Kocaeli software schools, which does not have a separate legal personality; all administrative, legal, and operational processes relating to the Competition shall be carried out by Bilişim Vadisi,
- **Vakıf Katılım:** The partner organization supporting the activities of 42 Türkiye and contributing to the theme, mentoring, and prize processes of the Competition,
- **Competition Schedule:** The period covering the application, evaluation, online development, final, and award processes,
- **General Rules:** The general provisions that participants must comply with throughout the Competition,
- **Code of Ethics:** The ethical and professional principles that participants are required to comply with.

## 1. PURPOSE OF THE COMPETITION

The Vakıf Katılım Hackathon is organized to support the development of innovative digital solutions that make the vakıf works and tangible cultural heritage of Türkiye more visible, accessible, and sustainable through technology.

As part of the Competition, participants are expected to develop digital products that go beyond simply listing historical artifacts. The products should demonstrate strong user experience, accessibility, design, technical infrastructure, data utilization, and innovation, while being scalable and capable of expanding to include new cities and artifacts.

The main problem statement of the Competition is as follows:

> *"How can we transform Türkiye's vakıf heritage into a next-generation digital experience that enables users to discover it, learn reliable information about it, and engage with cultural heritage through mobile or desktop devices?"*

## 2. SCOPE OF COMPETITION

Teams will develop a working mobile or desktop application addressing the main problem statement. The product is expected to enable users to discover multiple vakıf works, access historical information, visuals, and sources relating to these works, and interact with cultural content.

Teams may select one of the following areas of focus or develop an original approach that is aligned with the main problem statement:

- **Audio Guide and Digital Storytelling:** Experiences that convey the historical, cultural, and social context of vakıf works through audio tours, podcasts, or similar storytelling formats.
- **Accessibility-Focused Discovery:** Solutions developed according to universal design principles to address the diverse needs of users, particularly people with visual or hearing impairments and older adults.
- **Gamified Cultural Tour:** Applications that encourage users to discover multiple vakıf works through game mechanics such as badges, challenges, and levels.
- **Community-Contributed Digital Archive:** Systems that allow users to contribute photographs, memories, or information, with contributions incorporated into the platform following a moderation and approval process.

- Route Planner and City Tour Assistance Solutions that create personalized travel routes

covering multiple vakıf heritage sites based on the user's interests, available time, and location.

- **AR-Powered Journey Through Time:** Experiences that use augmented reality to recreate the historical appearance, restored versions, or historical transformation of heritage sites.
- **Open Category:** Teams may apply under an original area of focus, provided that their solution remains aligned with the purpose and main problem statement of the Competition.

***Note:*** *The areas listed above are provided as examples. Teams may develop their own original solution approach, provided that it remains aligned with the purpose and main problem statement of the Competition.*

***Note:*** *Submissions consisting solely of an idea, presentation, mock-up, wireframe, or static design prototype will not be accepted as the main product. Teams are required to demonstrate the core user flows through a functional MVP.*

The sponsoring organization plans to provide a semi-structured content package containing verified text, images, and sources relating to approximately 60–80 vakıf works across Türkiye's seven geographical regions. The dataset will not be provided in the form of a ready-to-use API or processed database. Teams are expected to transform the provided content into their own data models and use it within their applications.

## 3. PARTICIPATION REQUIREMENTS

- The Competition is open to students enrolled at 42 Türkiye and at global campuses within the 42 Network.
- Individual applications will not be accepted. Applications must be submitted as a team.
- Each participant may be a member of only one team. Applications involving participants who are found to be members of more than one team will be deemed invalid.
- Participants are responsible for ensuring that all information and documents provided during the application process are accurate, up to date, and complete.

### 3.1. Team Formation

- Each team must consist of a minimum of 2 and a maximum of 4 members.
- Each team is required to designate a Team Captain (Contact Person) from among its members.
- The allocation of roles and responsibilities among team members throughout the Competition is at the team's discretion.
- Any changes to the team composition after the finalist teams have been announced are subject to the approval of the Competition Organizer.

### 3.2. Responsibilities of the Contact Person

- Each team must designate a Team Captain (Contact Person) to coordinate with Bilişim Vadisi and the organizing team throughout the Competition.
- The Contact Person is responsible for keeping the contact information of team members up to date and promptly communicating all notifications received from the organizers to the team.
- The Contact Person is responsible for monitoring the Competition schedule, submission deadlines, online meetings, and announcements.
- All official correspondence, information updates, and document/product submissions made on behalf of the team shall be handled through the Contact Person.
- The respective team shall be responsible for any issues arising from delays, incomplete communication, or failure to communicate on the part of the Contact Person.

### 3.3. Competition Process

The Competition process will consist of the application period, preliminary evaluation, notification of finalist teams, the kick-off meeting, the online preparation and development period, the development marathon to be held as part of the in-person final event, and the final presentations.

- Official communications regarding the Competition process will be sent to the team's Contact Person through the communication channels designated by the organizers.
- Finalist teams may receive guidance throughout the process from entrepreneurship and subject-matter expert mentors provided by the organizers.
- Mentorship support is advisory in nature. The development of the product, technical decision-making, and completion of all submissions remain the responsibility of the team.
- The final event will be held in person, and finalist teams are required to be present at the date, time, and venue specified by the organizers.

### 3.4. Application Requirements

Applications will be submitted online through the application channel announced by 42 Türkiye. Before applying, participants are required to read and accept the Competition information, privacy notice, participation requirements, and these Terms and Conditions.

During the application stage, teams are expected to provide the following information:

- Basic information about the team and its members,
- The problem they intend to address and the target user group,
- The proposed solution and key user scenarios,
- The technologies and development approach they plan to use,
- The innovative aspects of the solution and its contribution to cultural heritage,
- The product's approach to scalability and sustainability.

Any changes to an application after the application deadline are subject to the approval of the organizers. Applications found to contain false, misleading, or incomplete information may be excluded from the evaluation process.

## 4. COMPETITION SCHEDULE

| DATE | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|
| 21 September 2026 | Application opening |
| 3 October 2026 | Application deadline |
| 3–7 October 2026 | Application evaluation |
| 7 October 2026 | Announcement of finalist teams |
| 8 October 2026 | Online kick-off meeting |
| 8 October – 7 November 2026 | Online development period |
| 7-8 November 2026 | In-person final event and award ceremony |

***Note:*** *The organizers reserve the right to make changes to the Competition schedule when deemed necessary. Any changes will be communicated to participants through the official communication channels.*

## 5. SCORING AND EVALUATION

Projects will be evaluated based on a combination of factors, including technical feasibility, user experience, accessibility, innovation, data utilization, alignment with the problem statement, and the final presentation. The final scoring weights and evaluation criteria may be announced separately by the organizers.

### 5.1 Technical Evaluation

The technical evaluation will focus not only on the visual integrity of the project, but also on whether it functions as a fully working end-to-end product, as well as its use of data, technical sustainability, and potential for further development.

#### 5.1.1. Application Functionality and MVP

- A functional mobile or desktop application must be developed.
- The application must enable users to discover multiple vakıf works.
- Users must be able to access historical information, visuals, and sources relating to the works.
- The application must provide the ability to add new content and edit existing content.
- The system must be designed to support the addition of new vakıf works.
- The core user flows must be demonstrated end-to-end during the final event.
- A presentation, screenshots, or a static design does not qualify as a working product demonstration.

#### 5.1.2 Technical Architecture and Scalability

- Teams are free to choose the programming languages, frameworks, databases, and development tools they use.
- The application architecture is expected to be extensible to support the addition of new works, cities, and content types.
- The core system architecture and data model must be explainable during the final presentation.
- Teams may use third-party APIs or services. It is the team's responsibility to ensure that all services used in the final demo are operational and functional.
- When using open-source libraries and components, teams must comply with the applicable licensing requirements.

### 5.1.3. Data Management and Content Accuracy

- Teams are expected to transform the provided raw or semi-structured content into a data model appropriate to the needs of their application.
- Where necessary, data cleaning, classification, tagging, and relationship mapping should be carried out by the team.
- Source information should be displayed for historical and cultural content presented to users.
- Unverified content must not be presented as factual information.
- If a community-contributed solution is developed, it must include a moderation and approval mechanism to review user contributions before they are published.

### 5.1.4. User Experience and Accessibility

- The interface is expected to be clear, consistent, and designed to support the core user scenarios.
- The application must provide a readable, navigable, and interactive experience appropriate to the type of device being used.
- Depending on the nature of the solution, accessibility features such as screen reader compatibility, alternative text, high contrast, appropriate font sizes, color-blind-friendly design, audio narration, subtitles, or keyboard navigation may be incorporated.
- Accessibility features are expected to be integrated into the working product wherever reasonably possible, rather than being demonstrated solely through design mock-ups.

### 5.1.5. Security, Testing and Code Quality

- User inputs are expected to be subject to appropriate validation and control mechanisms.
- If personal or sensitive data is processed, the necessary technical measures must be implemented to protect such data.
- The product must be tested with respect to the core user flows and critical functionalities.
- The source code is expected to be maintained in a readable, modular, and maintainable structure.
- It is recommended that basic setup and run instructions required to operate the project be documented.

### 5.2. Additional Evaluation Criteria

#### 5.2.1 Problem Alignment and Cultural Value

- The solution directly addresses the main problem statement of the Competition.
- It meaningfully addresses a genuine user need.
- It makes a tangible contribution to the visibility and discoverability of vakıf works, learning about them, or engaging with cultural heritage.

#### 5.2.2. Innovation and Data Utilization

- The solution offers an original value proposition that differentiates it from existing approaches.
- Technology is used meaningfully to address user needs rather than solely for presentation purposes.
- The provided dataset is accurately and effectively incorporated into the product experience.

#### 5.2.3. Teamwork and Communication

- Clear distribution of roles and ownership of the project among team members,
- Professional and effective communication between the team and the mentors, jury, and organizing team,
- Demonstration by team members during the final presentation of a strong understanding of the technical and functional aspects of the solution they developed

### 5.3. Final Evaluation and Scoring

The final evaluation will consider the technical product, alignment with the problem statement, user experience, accessibility, innovation, data utilization, scalability, and presentation performance as a whole.

The scoring weights for the evaluation criteria will be finalized by the organizers and communicated to the finalist teams. Following the jury's evaluations, the teams receiving the highest final scores will be ranked accordingly. In the event of a tie or any special circumstances relating to the evaluation process, the final decision shall rest with the jury and Bilişim Vadisi.

### 5.4. Presentation and Final Scoring

Finalist teams are expected to present their projects before the jury and conduct a live product demonstration covering the core user scenarios. The presentation must clearly address the project problem, target users, developed solution, technical architecture, data utilization, innovative features, and scalability approach.

Final presentations must be delivered by team members. It is not permitted for a person who is not a member of the team to present on behalf of the team. The presentation duration, presentation template, technical submission formats, and requirements for the competition venue will be communicated separately after the finalist teams have been announced.

The seven-member jury planned to participate in the final evaluation will consist of the following:

**5.4.1** Bilişim Vadisi: 2 jury members
**5.4.2** Vakıf Katılım: 2 jury members
**5.4.3** Independent: 2 jury members
**5.4.4** Directorate General of Foundations: 1 jury member

## 6. PRIZES

Following the conclusion of the Competition, each member of the winning teams is planned to receive the prizes listed below:

| RANK | PRIZE |
|---|---|
| FIRST PLACE | MacBook Air M5 13" |
| SECOND PLACE | iPad Air M4 13” |
| THIRD PLACE | iPad 11” |

***Note:*** *The prizes specified above will be awarded individually to all members of the winning teams listed in their application.*

## 7. COMMUNICATION

Participants are responsible for following official announcements, emails, and question-and-answer communications shared by the organizers regarding the Competition. Bilişim Vadisi shall not be

held responsible for any lack of information resulting from participants' failure to follow such announcements.

The communication channels for the application and Competition process will be announced by the organizers together with the application announcement.

## 8. GENERAL RULES

- All participants who apply to the Competition shall be deemed to have accepted the terms and conditions set forth herein.
- Teams are prohibited from interfering without authorization with the work, systems, or data of other teams during the Competition.
- Teams are responsible for ensuring that they have the necessary rights and licenses to use any third-party software, content, visuals, data, or similar components incorporated into their projects.
- Finalist teams must comply with the submission formats and deadlines specified by the organizers.
- Bilişim Vadisi shall have the authority to make decisions on matters not expressly addressed in these Terms and Conditions.
- The organizers may make technical and operational arrangements as deemed necessary to ensure the proper and fair conduct of the Competition.

## 9. CODE OF ETHICS

- Projects must consist primarily of the original work of the team members. Unauthorized copying of work belonging to other individuals or teams, or presenting such work as one's own, is prohibited.
- Participants are required to respect intellectual and industrial property rights, copyrights, and the rights of third parties.
- Throughout the Competition, participants must behave professionally and respectfully toward other teams, mentors, jury members, and organizers.
- Solutions that may constitute a security breach, contain malicious software, or enable unauthorized access to third-party systems may not be used within the scope of the Competition.

- If conduct in violation of the Code of Ethics is identified, the relevant team may be excludon process or disqualified from the Competition.

## 10. LIABILITY STATEMENT

Teams are responsible for ensuring that the products they develop, as well as the data and third-party components they use, comply with applicable laws, licensing terms, and relevant legislation. Bilişim Vadisi and the organizers shall not be held liable for any damage that teams may cause to third parties.

If any false statement in the application information, plagiarism, intellectual property infringement, unethical conduct, or any situation that compromises the security of the Competition is identified, the team's application may be deemed invalid, excluded from the evaluation process, or the team may be disqualified from the Competition.

Bilişim Vadisi **reserves the right to make any changes to these Terms and Conditions that it deems necessary**. Any such changes will be communicated to participants through the official communication channels.